Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 5
♥ A 6 3
♦ A 8 2
♣ A J 4 3

♠ 9 7 6
♥ 10 9 8 7
♦ J 9 6 3
♣ 9 5

♠ 10 8 4 3
♥ J 5 2
♦ 10 4
♣ K 10 8 6

♠ A J 2
♥ K Q 4
♦ K Q 7 5
♣ Q 7 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♥10

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥10, won by dummy's ♥A. At trick 2 South calls for dummy's ♣3.

Play the ♣6.

You would not have been expecting South to play a small ♣ from dummy's holding. The only way it makes sense is if South holds the ♣Q.

If you play your ♣K you will win the trick, but in so doing you will set up 3 ♣ tricks for South, which is all he needs to make the slam.

Play low instead and South will win his ♣Q. But now your ♣ K 10 sits behind dummy's ♣ J 4 so he can get only one more trick in the suit, the ♣A.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ K J 10 9 3
♦ 7 2
♣ K J 10

♠ J 10 9 6
♥ —
♦ 10 8 6 4 3
♣ A 8 4 3

♠ 8 4 3
♥ 7 4
♦ Q J 9 5
♣ Q 9 7 5

♠ A Q 5
♥ A Q 8 6 5 2
♦ A K
♣ 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠J

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠J, the ♠K is played from dummy and holds the trick. Next come dummy's ♥K, then another trump to South's ♥A.

At trick 4 South plays the ♣2 from his hand and you must decide what to play.

Play the ♣3 (smoothly).

South has 2 small ♣s and faces a choice of dummy plays in the suit. He must decide whether to play you for the ♣A or the ♣Q. If you play your ♣A you make the decision very easy for him.

When you correctly play your small ♣ life becomes harder for South. Sometimes he will guess correctly and play dummy's ♣K, but other times he will play dummy's ♣J, hoping you have the ♣Q.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 5 4 ♥ J 6 2 ♦ J 8 5 2 ♣ A K Q 2	
♠ 10 8 7 6 2 ♥ 10 5 4 ♦ K 6 ♣ J 9 6	N W E S	♠ A 9 3 ♥ Q 9 8 ♦ A 7 3 ♣ 10 8 5 4
	♠ K Q J ♥ A K 7 3 ♦ Q 10 9 4 ♣ 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♠6

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠6. You won the ♠A and returned the ♠9, won by South's ♠Q.

South next played to dummy's ♣A and led the ♦2. What do you play?

Play the ♦A.

Count the points. South's 15-17 plus North's 11 plus your 10 comes to 36-38. So West has room for an Ace or a King, but no more.

West's second ♠ play was the 2, so it looks like he started with 5 ♠s. And the fall of South's ♠s looks like he may have 1 ♠ left, very likely the ♠K.

All this means that you should take your ♦A now and return your last ♠ to establish West's suit. Now West's ♦K will be an entry to the ♠s

If you play low, West will have to take the ♦K now, and although he can play a ♠ to establish the suit, he will not have an entry to be able to cash them.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q 8 6 ♥ K 7 5 3 ♦ A Q 5 ♣ 8 4	
♠ 9 4 ♥ A 2 ♦ 10 6 4 3 ♣ Q J 10 7 5		♠ 5 2 ♥ Q J 10 ♦ J 9 8 2 ♣ 9 6 3 2
	♠ A J 10 7 3 ♥ 9 8 6 4 ♦ K 7 ♣ A K	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣Q

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣Q, East plays low and South wins the ♣A.

South pulls trumps in 2 rounds. He then takes the ♦K, ♦Q, ♦A, discarding a ♥ on the last one. Next he plays dummy's last ♣ to his ♣K.

Having done all this, South now plays a low ♥ from his hand. What do you play?

Play the ♥A.

If you followed what South was doing you will realize that he has eliminated both the ♦s and ♣s from both his hand and dummy. If it isn't clear that he is now out of ♣s, just remember the bidding - he must have had 5 ♠s and 4 ♥s.

Suppose you play low on this ♥ (as South hopes you will). Dummy's ♥K will take the trick, and when another ♥ is played you will have to win it with your now bare ♥A. You will then have to play a ♦ or a ♣, giving South a ruff and sluff.

But if you take your ♥A now, then exit with your ♥2, South can win the ♥K but will still have to lose a ♥ to East.

Board 5
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 7 2
♥ J 8 7 3 2
♦ A K Q
♣ A K

♠ K Q J 9 5
♥ —
♦ 9 6 4 2
♣ 9 6 5 3

♠ 8 4 3
♥ Q 10 4
♦ 8 7 3
♣ J 8 7 4

♠ A 6
♥ A K 9 6 5
♦ J 10 5
♣ Q 10 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♦	Pass	3NT
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠K

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

West led the ♠K, won by South's ♠A. South played a small ♣ to dummy's ♣A, then led dummy's ♥J.

What do you play? ♥Q or ♥4?

Play the ♥4.

Remember that South opened 1♥, so he has 5 of them. With only 3 trumps out he has no intention of finessing. Perhaps he led the ♥J just to tempt you to cover in this situation.

If you play low he will win with one of his high ♥s and then you will have a sure ♥ winner. Along with the ♠ winner West has you will defeat the slam.

If you cover the ♥J with your ♥Q South will again win with one of his high ones. But now the position will be clear to South and he will return to dummy and play another ♥, finessing your ♥10. With no trump loser he will make the slam.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 6
♥ 10 5 4
♦ A K 3
♣ A Q 7 4

♠ A 9 5 2
♥ 7 2
♦ 8 6 4
♣ 10 8 5 3

♠ K 10 7 4
♥ A 3
♦ J 10 9 2
♣ K J 9

♠ 8 3
♥ K Q J 9 8 6
♦ Q 7 5
♣ 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♥2

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You decide a trump lead is called for and lead the ♥2. Your partner wins with the ♥A and plays the ♦J. South lets this go to dummy's ♦K, (but you know he has ♦Q), then plays a trump back to his ♥K, pulling the 2 outstanding trumps from West and East.

South's next play is the ♠3 from his hand. Do you play your ♠A or not?

Play the ♠A.

Even if South doesn't have the ♠K he can establish a ♠ winner just by leading twice toward the ♠ Q J. That winner will take care of whatever black-suit loser he may have.

If East has a ♣ trick it is important to get it established soon. So go up with the ♠A and play a ♣ through dummy's ♣ A Q. When South tries the ♠ suit again **EAST** can win and cash his ♣K for the setting trick.

If you play low on South's ♠ play East will be forced to win the trick and he cannot profitably attack the ♣ suit from his side.